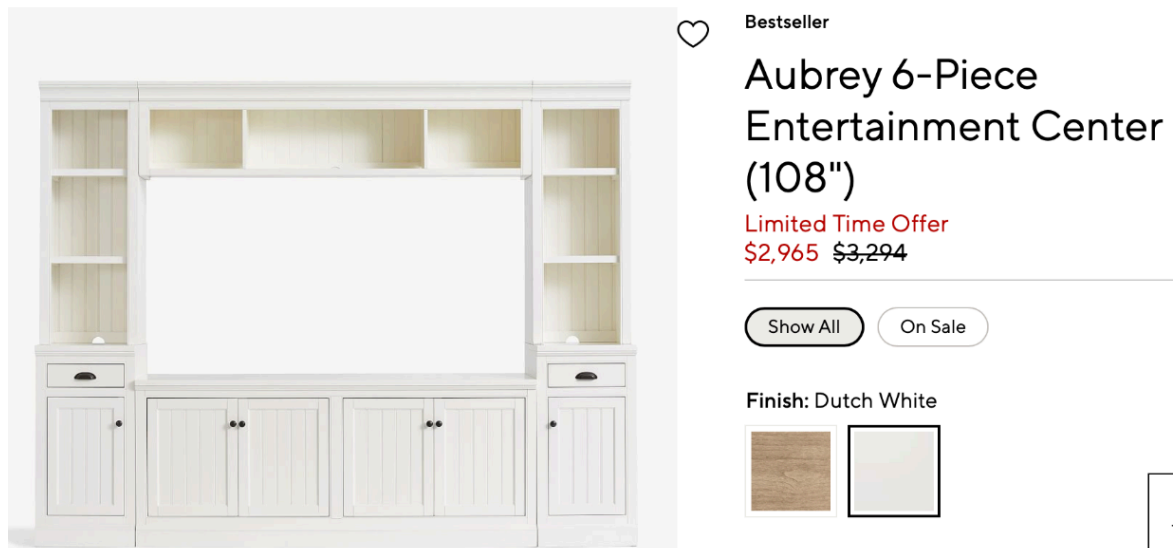


Element B: Documentation and Analysis of Prior Solution Attempts

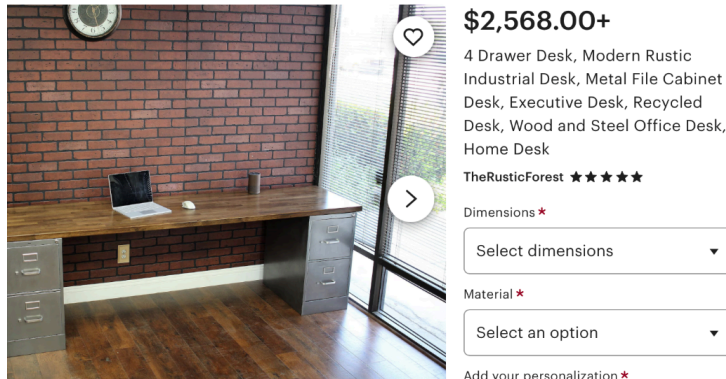
The development office at our independent boarding and day school has an overflow of items. The excess items piled on the floor hinder workflow and efficiency. Many items move around the development office; therefore, it is important to keep them organized. The current storage situation is unsatisfactory in the eyes of school donors and visitors.

A built-in cabinet is a strong and permanent storage option that would fit the development office space. A permanent cabinet helps keep things organized and hidden, making the area look neat. However, once it is installed, it can not be moved, which limits flexibility. It is roughly \$2965 to \$3500 and usually requires a professional to install (Potterybarn, 2025) .



Potterybarn Built in Cabinet

Another option is file cabinets with a countertop, which provide both storage and a work surface. This setup helps with organization and also gives a usable space for hosting guests. It is usually more affordable than a built-in cabinet and can be moved if needed. However, file cabinets can take up a lot of space.



Etsy File Cabinet

A laptop desk on wheels is a small, movable desk that is easy to work in different places. The desk will take up less space and will be adjusted to need, and is ideal for the student workers who need a workspace in the office. However, it is not as sturdy as a built-in desk or traditional desk.



The current setup lacks proper storage, leaving boxes exposed and making the room feel messy instead of welcoming. More storage is needed for books, paper, shirts, and other supplies while still maintaining the room's antique charm, which is being hidden by the clutter. The office space is cluttered, there are boxes that are scattered on the floor and artwork placed chaotically on the coffee table and floor. While the office is meant for planning events and storing supplies, donor relations and much more, the lack of proper organization has only made the clutter worse

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over time. Previous attempts to organize the space failed to address the root of the problem, leading to increased disarray. Although the artwork and antiques add elegance, they contribute to the mess when not properly displayed. The biggest issue is the absence of a real storage system, causing boxes and other items to pile up, making it difficult to move around and preventing the space from looking professional. Since faculty, staff, students, and donors frequently use the office, this ongoing disorganization affects both its appearance and functionality. Without proper storage, maintaining order becomes a challenge, slowing down event planning and daily tasks. This disorder also reduces workflow and makes it harder for those working in the office to focus.



Ms. C's desk



Ms. P's Desk



Boxes and files that need to be stored



Perspective students and guests area to work

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